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MONTES CLAROS – MG
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Atividade avaliativa apresentada para
atendimento de requisito parcial para
aprovação na disciplina Inglês Instrumental em
Bacharelado em Sistemas de Informação – 2º
período

Professor: Josélia

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"2 - Privacy and Agentic AI: Studying privacy risks when autonomous AI agents access personal data to perform tasks on behalf of the user."

Developments in AI are reshaping multiple domains, including cybersecurity. Implemented well, these technologies can assist and support human operators in detecting, defending and responding to cyberthreats. However, they can also pose serious risks such as data leaks, cyberattacks and online harms if they malfunction, or are misused. Governments must take a forward-looking, practical and collaborative approach to developing and using emerging technologies safely, as their capabilities and risks continue to evolve. The risks transcend borders, and the challenge is to maximize AI's benefits, including to strengthen our cyber resilience, while minimizing its risks.

— Josephine Teo, Minister for Digital Development and Information and Minister-in-Charge of Cybersecurity and Smart Nation Group, Singapore

Data leaks associated with genAI (34%) and the advancement of adversarial capabilities (29%) stand out as leading concerns for 2026. This marks a striking reversal from previous years – in 2025, advancement of adversarial capabilities topped the list at 47% compared to only 22% for data leaks associated with genAI. Following this trend, reports from the first quarter of 2026 indicate that 62% of companies have already integrated autonomous agents into critical workflows, yet less than 20% have implemented "runtime monitoring" protocols to detect real-time data exfiltration.

The shift underscores a turning point in the AI risk landscape for the upcoming year: while the "AI arms race" between attackers and defenders continues to intensify, attention is pivoting from purely offensive innovation with AI towards the unintended exposure and misuse of sensitive data through generative and agentic systems.

Autonomous AI agents pose significant privacy risks when accessing personal data to perform tasks on behalf of the user, such as leaks due to excessive permissions or malicious manipulations.

Main Risks

Agentic AI agents often receive broad access to sensitive data, such as emails, credit cards, and schedules, without automatic revocation, facilitating accidental or intentional exposures. A critical vector in 2026 is "Indirect Prompt Injection," where agents, while processing malicious emails or websites, are instructed to divert financial data to external servers without the owner's consent. Alignment failures or "black boxes" can generate unauthorized inferences about individuals, violating principles like data minimization and purpose limitation. Additionally, "superusers" with excessive privileges create breaches for Shadow AI, where corporate data leaks via unsecured APIs. It is estimated that the use of unsanctioned agents (Shadow Agentic AI) has grown by 45% over the past year, complicating the control of traditional data perimeters.

Real Cases

In 2024, a financial services agent was manipulated to reveal customer data in a sophisticated attack. In early 2026, a failure in Moltbook's OpenClaw exposed credentials of 1 million users and data from 6,000 operators. In March 2026, a recursion error in a major airline's booking agent resulted in the leak of passports and itineraries for 450,000 customers after the bot interpreted a "help" command as a database export request. Other incidents include Samsung banning genAI after a source code leak via ChatGPT and Meta exposing user dialogues on Facebook and WhatsApp.

Relevant Regulations

Turkey's Data Protection Authority warned in 2026 about multi-stage personal data processing by agents, requiring transparency and accountability. In Brazil, the LGPD demands rigorous governance for agentic AI, with compliance in privacy policies. A new 2026 update from the ANPD (National Data Protection Authority) requires autonomous agents to maintain an auditable "decision log" accessible to the data subject. Globally, the EU AI Act classifies these systems as "high risk," mandating conformity assessments and human intervention.

Mitigation Measures

Apply the principle of least privilege: limit data access to essentials, use temporary credentials, and require human approval for critical actions. Implement regular audits, encryption in communications, and emergency buttons to block anomalous agents. The use of Privacy-Enhancing Technologies (PETs), such as Differential Privacy, becomes essential in 2026 to ensure that the continuous training of agents does not expose sensitive data from individual users. Train users to avoid sensitive prompts and ensure LGPD/GDPR compliance via anonymization and transparency.

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